SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA

WORK-LIFE BALANCE AND ITS IMPACT ON JOB SATISFACTION AMONG PORTERS: BASIS FOR COMMUNITY EXTENSION PROGRAM

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CHAPTER 1

THE PROBLEM AND ITS SCOPE

1.1 Background of the study

Work-life balance is the ability of individuals to fulfill their jobs well, fulfill commitments made with family and other responsibilities, such as work and activities outside of work (Alameeri, Alshurideh, Al Kurdi, & Salloum, 2021). For porters, who are manual workers in Pier who are responsible for carrying, assisting passengers, moving goods, luggages, cargo, and other heavy items, making this balance difficult to achieve as they often face long hours, low income, no benefits, and physically demanding work, with some even taking extra jobs just to meet their basic needs often limit their ability to manage family responsibilities and maintain overall job satisfaction. Many studies have demonstrated that individuals who are able to strike a balance between their personal and professional duties are better working, motivated, and content with their employment. Satisfied employees are more flexible and increase productivity in their work (Katebi et al., 2022; Rafic et al.,2022). Porters, however, often manage longer hours, physically demanding job with no support and resources, making it harder for them to achieve satisfaction and work-life balance. This may lead to stress and decrease job satisfaction since an increased number of working hours or a more unusual shift schedule increases their chances of burnout (Vargas-Benitez et al., 2023). Experts believe that job satisfaction leads to motivation, loyalty, and commitment (Gazi, et al., 2024). When porters feel satisfied, they are more likely to stay engaged, productive, and committed. Therefore, job satisfaction is essential for workers to be motivated and committed to their work (Vargas-Benítez et al., 2023).

In today's international landscape, work-life balance has become one of the significant impacts on job satisfaction for modern workplaces. Good balancing of health and work helps improve performance for manual workers, including porters, especially with strong organizational

support (Previtali et al., 2022 and Jayaraman et al., 2023). Based on the study of Obrenovic et al., (2020) states that organizations are the ones responsible for promoting fair labor and work environments that empower workers to feel respect, support and satisfaction. The study of Chan (2020) job satisfaction for manual workers, particularly porters and other laborers, is influenced by their work–life balance and the support provided in their workplace. Companies that enforce strategic policies and principles promoting work-life balance tend to develop dedicated and employee loyalty (Agarwal & Bhakuni, 2024). According to Gustina et al. (2025) and Susana et al. (2022) revealed that work-life balance strongly affects job satisfaction, supporting the need for a promoting work environment and improving workers productivity and retention. Agarwal and Bhakuni (2024) confirm that healthy work-life balance leads to high job satisfaction and better performance. As stated by Baxi & Atre (2024), maintaining a satisfying and motivated workplace environment is essential for consistent service quality and organizational success. When manual workers experience job satisfaction, they build happiness, loyalty, and commitment (Hidayat & Ariyanto 2021).

In the Philippines, excessive work has become a major concern in the work environment. Many employees face pressure in the workplace because of the high working demands and tension. Workers who maintain a healthier work-life balance are more productive and fulfilled with their jobs, have reduced stress, and enhanced performance (Malaki, 2024). According to Yapo (2023), due to various roles and obligations, many workers experience a high level of stress that results in specific forms of stress, such as rising turnover intent, reduced performance, lower job satisfaction, increased depression, and anxiety. Locally, there is a lack of studies on work-life balance and job satisfaction among porters, making it difficult to determine their impact. It suggests that more studies are needed to understand challenges, long-term impacts and influencing factors to support decision-making (Agarwal and Bhakuni 2024). Most studies focused

only on other professions, such as teachers, office workers, and corporate employees, primarily ignoring the experiences of workers (Escarilla et al., 2025; Lagrana & Bayoneta, 2021; Dalid, 2025; Rose Lunas 2024).

The main objective of this study is to determine how the level of work-life balance experienced by the porters affects their overall job satisfaction and to understand how the demands of their profession, combined with their personal lives, affect their contentment with their job. Porters were selected because they are an essential yet understudied workforce whose demanding tasks and unstable working conditions make them highly vulnerable to challenges in work-life balance and job satisfaction. The researchers intend to identify the relationship between work-life balance on job satisfaction, and the experiences of what community extension programs implemented among porters in Nasipit, Agusan del Norte. By conducting this research, we seek to address problems and experiences faced by porters in maintaining work and personal lives. The study will serve as a basis for developing a community extension program to strengthen the quality of life and job contentment.

This study will explore the work-life balance and its impacts on job satisfaction among porters at Nasipit Port, focusing on a group that are an essential yet understudied workforce whose demanding tasks and unstable working conditions make it very hard for them to balance work and personal life. It aims to provide valuable information and knowledge faced by the respondents that can serve as a reference for various stakeholders. Porters will directly benefit through the community extension program that can improve their working conditions and quality of life, which can lead to better health, it can reduce stress and recognize the importance of their role in the workforce. Government/Policymakers can use the results as this provide research-based evidence to support the development of labor policies, create and improve policies, benefits, and programs. The results will guide them in making fair policies and programs that

protect and support workers who are ignored, especially porters. Lastly, future researchers will find this study valuable as it provides new information about a group that has rarely been studied in this context, providing a foundation for future studies on related topics. It also contributes to the body of knowledge on labor practices and work-life balance.

1.2 Review of Related Literature

Balancing work and life are essential for employee wellness. For porters operating in a physical setting with unpredictable hours, it is important to maintain a balance between work and personal life. This chapter seeks to analyze the influence of work-life balance on job satisfaction for porters.

AGE

Age significantly influences individuals' management of their work-life balance. Research indicates that each generation encounters distinct challenges and employs varying strategies to address them. The International Labour Organization (2023) said that younger workers are more likely to work longer hours and have less job security, which makes it harder for them to balance work and life. Many older workers seek jobs that offer both stability and flexibility to match their changing needs. Age still affects how employees view and manage their work-life balance. Fernandez and Lebin (2022) provide valuable insights through their study, particularly relevant to porters, whose physically demanding roles underscore the significance of age-sensitive work-life balance strategies. Younger porters often appreciate flexible shifts that help them develop skills and explore interests. For older porters, ergonomic tools, manageable workloads, and full benefits help them stay healthy and satisfied at work.

Gumpal and Cardenas (2021) say that Filipino workers' views on work-life balance are shaped by their generation. The research revealed that both Baby Boomers and Millennials prioritize a harmony between their work and personal lives, shifting their emphasis as obligations

change. For porters, whose demanding jobs require targeted support, these generational differences are essential. Baby Boomers and Millennials tend to seek regular routines and general health, while members of Generation X might prefer more flexible options to accommodate shifting priorities.

Particularly in physically demanding jobs like portering, age continues to be a defining factor in how employees view and manage work-life balance. But there is still a significant disconnect in how organizations convert these generational preferences into workable workplace regulations. Despite growing awareness, many individuals still adopt one-size-fits-all approaches that fail to address the nuanced needs of different age groups. By acknowledging and responding to these generational distinctions, organizations can foster a more balanced, resilient, and age-inclusive workforce.

GENDER

Gender plays a significant role in the experience of work-life balance and career advancement. Malap and Mungekar (2024) examined the influence of traditional gender roles on work-life balance, highlighting that men historically viewed as breadwinners are now more engaged in household duties. Still, societal pressures persist in pushing them to concentrate on their careers, leading to continual disparity between their work and personal lives.

Pace and Sciotto (2021) studied gender difference found that women often see fewer chances for career growth and report worse health when their work-life balance is off. The research showed that men gain more flexible work schedules, leading to better health and greater happiness at work. Based on these result, work-life balance policies should consider the need of different groups. This can help everyone in the workforce have equal chances of career growth and well-being.

These results are especially important for male porters, who may hide their emotional stress because of what society expects of them, which makes them more likely to burn out. Extension programs should actively work to make mental health support normal, especially for male porters. They should create spaces where emotional well-being is important, and people are encouraged to ask for help.

INCOME

The Philippines Labour Market Profile (2025) provides a sobering view of economic conditions faced by manual laborers, particularly porters and other informal workers. The report notes that many workers, particularly students and young adults, rely on manual labor to support their families. This is common in urban areas and transport hubs, where physically demanding jobs are available without informal qualifications. Workers in the informal sector usually make less than the national average and miss out on benefits like health insurance, paid leave, or retirement plans since they do not have formal contracts.

The Philippines Statistics Authority's Income and Expenditure Survey (2025) shows that manual labor roles, such as portering, are mainly found in lower income groups. The Philippine Social Science Council's Family Income and Expenditure Survey (2021) shows that regions such as Caraga have much lower average incomes than the National Capital Region. According to Al-Mamari (2024), people with higher incomes often have flexible work options and supportive policies that help them manage stress and maintain a healthy work-life balance. In contrast, those with lower incomes usually have strict schedules and less control over their time, making it harder to balance work and personal life. This research highlights how economic factors shape work-life quality and shows why it is important for workplaces to support the well-being of all employees, no matter their income level.

For manual laborers, including porters, income serves as the principal means of sustaining their livelihoods. These workers often work long hours in tough conditions and usually have little job security. Their income provides for essential needs such as nutrition, influences the level of familial support available, determines access to healthcare services, and impacts opportunities for rest. A lot of porters must put their health on hold because they don't always make enough money.

RELATIONSHIP STATUS

Studies suggest that people who are married or in a relationship often experience better work-life balance because they can share responsibilities and support each other at home. For manual workers in demanding, low-income jobs, having a stable relationship may help reduce work-related stress. Recent demographic shifts necessitate a detailed examination of variations in work-life satisfaction across distinct relationship-status groups. Previous studies have often overlooked these differences and treated all unmarried groups as the same (Kislev, 2019; Sassler & Lichter, 2020). Kislev (2022) emphasizes that although single people might not have the conventional obligations linked to family life like raising children, supporting a partner, or managing a household, they remain vulnerable to work-life conflict.

Previous studies show that extra work can be as difficult for single workers as for those who are married. This suggests we should examine how workload affects people with different relationship statuses. Culpepper et al. (2020) point out that single individuals are often underrepresented in work-life balance (WLB) research, even though numerous studies have shown that increased workload consistently lowers WLB satisfaction levels (Dyrbye et al., 2020; Johari et al., 2018). Some research shows that the negative effects of heavy workloads are similar for both single and married workers. Some believe that single workers are better equipped to handle work demands than those who are married. Porters often have difficult jobs with little

legal protection. They work long hours, have unpredictable schedules, and get little rest. Consequently, both single and married porters experience significant challenges in maintaining equilibrium between occupational responsibilities and personal life. For married porters, demanding workloads frequently strain familial relationships and limit opportunities for family engagement. In contrast, single porters often experience social isolation, reduced emotional support, and limited opportunities for leisure or personal development. These conditions collectively impede the attainment of a healthy work-life balance. Furthermore, evolving societal attitudes toward relationships have influenced how workers navigate professional responsibilities and personal lives. Family situations shape how people balance work and personal life, especially when strong support systems are not available.

The Philippines Statistics Authority, there were 414,213 legally recognized marriages in 2023. This is a drop of 7.8% from 2022. This drop is part of a larger trend in the country where people are living together and putting off marriage, especially low-income workers who can't afford to get married. Informal partnerships often lack institutional support or legal safeguards, and these evolving relationship dynamics influence work-life balance by altering individuals' management of familial and professional obligations. Various family arrangements affect how people balance.

YEARS OF EXPERIENCE

Years of experience are very important for achieving a good work-life balance. Employees who have been with an organization for numerous years tend to develop more effective strategies for managing stress and heavy workloads. According to Thilagavathy and Geetha (2023), manual laborers often experience high levels of physical strain and limited flexibility, making it challenging for them to balance their personal and professional lives. Bello and Tanko (2020) added that years

of experience can help these workers develop better coping strategies and boundary-setting skills, which will help them deal with stress and role conflict more effectively.

According to the World Economic Forum (2025), flexibility and experience at work are important for maintaining a healthy work-life balance. Workers with more tenure typically report lower levels of burnout and greater life satisfaction. These findings suggest that extended employment duration and organizational support are critical factors in enhancing employee satisfaction. It also suggests that work-life balance strategies should be tailored to different levels of individual experience.

To sum up, experience plays a key role in how manual laborers like porters manage their work and personal lives. As people gain more professional experience, they become better at handling physical demands, setting clear boundaries at work, and dealing with job-related stress.

EDUCATIONAL ATTAINMENT

Educational attainment refers to the highest level of education completed by the porters. Understanding their educational background helps identify how education may influence their work performance, job satisfaction, and ability to balance work and personal life. It provides context for analyzing their needs and challenges in the workplace. Unskilled manual workers often face challenges that affect their psychological well-being, and education plays an important role in this.

Park and Kim (2021) found that unskilled manual workers with lower education experience lower job satisfaction, reduced support from supervisors, and more negative work environments, which can lead to stress and diminished well-being; importantly, it is the combination of low education and difficult working conditions not manual labor itself that drives these outcomes, suggesting that improving educational access and workplace support can enhance mental health and job satisfaction. Similarly, Vyas (2022) highlighted how the COVID-19

pandemic reshaped work environments, noting that highly educated workers often occupy roles that allow for remote or hybrid arrangements, providing better flexibility and work-life balance, while less-educated workers remain in physically demanding jobs with limited adaptability, higher job insecurity, and lower wages; reskilling and upskilling initiatives are therefore critical to reducing inequality and supporting these workers' well-being. In the context of labor migrants and porters, Mahato and Paudel (2023) emphasize that higher education and specialized training equip workers to perform tasks more efficiently, safely, and confidently, while limited education restricts professional growth and adaptability, enhancing access to education and skills development can improve competence, productivity, and career opportunities even in physically demanding roles, reinforcing the international evidence that knowledge and training significantly influence work outcomes and overall well-being.

The Labor Force Survey (LFS, 2022) shows that individuals with lower educational attainment are more likely to experience unemployment, underemployment, and end up in low-skilled, physically demanding jobs. This directly reflects the situation of porters, whose work depends more on physical labor than formal qualifications. With limited education, many porters have fewer opportunities for stable employment or career advancement, making them more vulnerable to informal, irregular, and low-income work conditions common in manual labor sectors. The World Bank Philippine Jobs Report (2023) suggests that workers with low educational attainment like many porters and manual laborers are more likely to stay in low-wage, informal, and physically demanding jobs with limited mobility. Because their skills do not match the requirements of more productive sectors, they face fewer opportunities for better employment and are more vulnerable during economic disruptions. Improving education and skills training is therefore essential to help porters move toward more stable and higher-quality jobs.

Educational attainment significantly shapes the work conditions and opportunities of porters, as those with lower education face greater job insecurity, limited mobility, and reduced well-being. Enhancing access to education, training, and skill development is essential to improving their job satisfaction, safety, and long-term career prospects.

NUMBER OF CHILDREN

This is an important demographic factor that helps explain the personal and economic pressures faced by porters or manual workers. Workers with more children often carry greater financial responsibilities and may experience increased stress in balancing work and family needs. This can influence their work-life balance, job satisfaction, and overall well-being. Understanding how family size affects porters' daily lives provides useful context for interpreting their challenges, priorities, and the support they may need in both their work and personal environments.

(Haar et al. 2019) the study found that family demands reduce work-life balance, meaning workers with more responsibilities, such as raising children, face greater difficulty balancing work and home. Although it did not focus on manual workers or porters, its results suggest that for workers with physically demanding jobs and limited support, having more children may further strain their work-life balance unless strong workplace support is available. Guo et al. (2025) researchers found that the number of children was a key predictor of fertility intention, with workers who already had more children being less likely to plan for additional children. Other important factors included age, marital status, monthly income, self-perceived economic status, and social support. These findings suggest that for manual workers, such as porters, who often have lower incomes and heavy workloads, the presence of existing children significantly reduces the likelihood of planning for more.

The number of children significantly shapes the personal and economic pressures faced by porters and manual workers. Larger family responsibilities can intensify stress, reduce work-life balance, and influence decisions about having more children, especially for low-income workers with physically demanding jobs. This highlights the need for adequate workplace and social support to help these workers manage both their professional and family obligations effectively.

OTHER MEANS OF INCOME

Porters often supplement their earnings through other sources of income due to the unpredictable nature of port work. These alternative income-generating activities may include providing additional services to passengers, running small side businesses, or helping with logistics for private clients. Such sources of income enable porters to improve financial stability and support their families despite the demands of their occupation.

Recent studies show that Filipino workers, especially those in informal jobs such as manual laborers and porters, face many challenges in earning a stable income. Ipsos (2025) reports that gig workers often rely on multiple income sources to survive, and the same is true for manual workers and porters who may take on additional jobs, engage in small-scale businesses, or depend on family support through remittance to meet their needs. Similarly, the World Bank (2022) highlights that low-skilled and informal workers are particularly vulnerable to poverty and inequality, often relying on remittances, domestic transfers, or side jobs to sustain their households. Misra, Kumari, and Sajid (2024) emphasize that the informal sector provides crucial employment opportunities, allowing workers to cope with limited formal work options, though these jobs often lack security and benefits. Fairwork Philippines (2023) also notes that platform and informal workers face risks to their health, safety, and financial stability, underlining the importance of additional income sources to manage these uncertainties.

Overall, these studies suggest that manual workers and porters depend not only on their primary income but also on other income sources to survive, highlighting their economic vulnerability and the importance of flexible earning strategies.

WORK-LIFE BALANCE

Lewis and Beauregard (2018) observe that no universally accepted definition of work-life balance exists. Instead, the concept includes multiple overlapping interpretations that vary across academic literature and organizational contexts. Early research defined work-life balance as the capacity to minimize conflict between professional and personal demands. This perspective suggests that balance is achieved when individuals effectively manage both professional and personal domains, minimizing stress and preventing substantial compromise. This framework underscores the necessity of maintaining clear boundaries between occupational and personal responsibilities.

Balancing work and personal life are essential for managing a team well. When employees have work-life balance, they are more likely to stay, feel satisfied with their jobs, and help the organization succeed. However, as the way we work changes and job demands grow, it is becoming more difficult for people to keep their work and personal lives apart. Work-life balance refers to the integration of work and personal responsibilities, which contributes to overall well-being and fulfillment.

According to Bataineh (2019), achieving work-life balance depends on valuing life and striving to reach important goals. Sandhiya (Kumar, 2025) explains that the term work-life balance was introduced in 1986 as people and organizations became more aware of how work and family life can influence each other. This awareness led to the ideas of work-family conflict and family-work conflict. The balance between work and personal life is shaped by numerous factors, both advantageous and disadvantageous. Conversely, long hours at work, elevated job demands, and

family pressures can greatly hinder a person's capacity to keep a healthy equilibrium between career and personal life. Sundary (2023) talks about the balance between work and non-work situations. To find that balance, people often must set aside time from work to focus on other parts of their lives. Kasran (2023) highlights work-life balance as a state in which individuals manage their time effectively, enabling them to meet both personal and professional demands. This balance leads to a healthier lifestyle, which in turn makes employees more productive. This idea often means putting family needs first, like taking care of kids, and cutting back on work hours to keep everything in balance. Foanto (2020) emphasizes the importance of efficient time and energy management, allowing employees to effectively balance their professional and familial responsibilities. Balancing these demands makes you more resilient and more flexible, and helps you live a healthier, more sustainable life at work and at home.

Dias et al. (2022) investigated the connection between organizational commitment, job satisfaction, and work-life balance. Their result indicate that organizational commitment does not directly influence employee work-life balance but serves as a link in improving job satisfaction. The difference is especially important for porters, who usually work in high-pressure, demanding situations with little room for errors. Especially for porters who usually operate in irregular, high-pressure, and with limited autonomy. Improving the workplace with inclusive behaviors that support and acknowledge employee engagement in the workplace can increase job satisfaction regardless of difficulties of balancing work and life. Anisha and Melvin (2020) claim that inconsistencies in work-life balance can significantly affect an individual's emotional and mental health. When work takes up most of our time, it can cause stress, tiredness, and make us feel cut off from life outside the office. Keeping a healthy work-life balance helps lower stress and prevents burnout. Ahmad Yani and M. Havidz Aima (2024) indicates that a positive work-life balance contributes to higher job satisfaction, which in turn enhances lecturers' ability to perform their

Tridharma duties effectively. Furthermore, the research emphasizes the importance of human resource management interventions, such as reasonable workload distribution, clear time boundaries, and access to health and wellness resources, to support lecturers in achieving a sustainable work-life balance. A good balance also boosts motivation and job satisfaction (Al-Fatiha et al., 2021). When people believe they work for an organization that values and supports their individual needs and goals, they often perform better and are happier. This may result in increased productivity.

Adisa and Chang (2024) highlights that the balance between work and personal life is essential for employee performance as well as their well-being. It is also acknowledged as a major factor in employee productivity, satisfaction, and the overall organizational success, which makes work-life balance a vital topic in all aspects. Bellman (2021) emphasizes how flexible scheduling and remote work can affect work-life balance and job satisfaction, particularly considering changing workplace norms. Moreover, Noda, H. (2020) emphasizes that work-life balance initiatives enhance job satisfaction and contribute to sustainable productivity and long-term organizational success. Hariri et al. (2024) investigated the relationship between work-life balance and employees' overall well-being. The study found that employees who maintained a healthy balance between their professional and personal lives reported significantly higher levels of job satisfaction, reduced stress, and improved mental health. It also highlighted that flexible working arrangements, supportive management, and reasonable workload expectations were key factors that enhanced employees' well-being. Conversely, poor work-life balance was associated with burnout, lower motivation, and decreased productivity. Overall, the findings emphasized that promoting work-life balance contributes positively to both employee welfare and organizational performance. These include job-related elements such as hours, workload, and autonomy, as well as the overall work environment, like supervisor support and company policies. Personal factors,

including commitment and family responsibilities, are also significant, especially when combined with financial and social pressures. As workplaces grow faster and more competitive, maintaining a healthy work-life balance is becoming harder for many people. As modern workplaces become increasingly busy, it's often challenging to maintain a clear separation between work and personal life. This can cause stress, burnout, and a general decline in health. To be happy in both your personal and professional life, you need to find a balance between work and life. Studies show that a well-maintained work-life balance leads to happier employees, better mental health, and better performance by the organization.

Maintaining a balance between work and life can help you feel less stressed and burned out. Basuni and Sopiah (2023) reviewed many studies to understand how work-life balance affects employee burnout. Their findings showed that employees who have a good balance between work and personal life experience less stress and burnout. However, when this balance is missing, workers often feel tired, unmotivated, and emotionally drained. The authors also found that most studies focus on the problem but do not clearly explain the causes of burnout or compare different types of jobs. Also, having a good work-life balance can make you more motivated and happier at work (Al-Fatiha et al., 2021). People tend to do better and be happier when they think they work for a company that cares about their individual needs and goals. This could lead to higher productivity. Work-life balance is increasingly recognized as a critical factor in enhancing employee productivity and efficiency. Magsayo and Saguban (2024) studied public workers in Lazi, Siquijor and found that both intrinsic and extrinsic motivation are more strongly connected to work-life balance in this area than in other Southeast Asian countries. Caringal-Go and Hechanova (2022) identified eight strategies dual-income Filipino workers use to manage work-life balance, including time management, faith, and family support. These findings suggest porters could benefit from personalized work-life

balance strategies, and that community programs might help by teaching practical skills like financial planning and family engagement.

Porters frequently face similar operational and logistical challenges. These findings highlight the necessity of incorporating policy advocacy and targeted training within comprehensive support plans. Research indicates that work-life balance is a multifaceted factor critical to the health and performance of essential workers, including porters. This shows that manual laborers, including porters, often lack focus due to their irregular and limited autonomy while performing physical tasks. Dealing with this encourages fairness in the workplace and is essential, particularly for manual laborers, to support and guarantee work-life balance, which results in their job satisfaction.

WORK FLEXIBILITY

Sa'adah and Sopiah (2022) characterize work flexibility as the ability of employees to determine the location and timing of their work-related tasks. Syahfitri, Absah, and Siahaan (2022) examined how employee training and the provision of facilities affect employee performance the study highlighted that work flexibility plays a key role in this relationship, as employees who can manage their work schedules alongside training and resources experience less stress and better work-life balance. This suggests that organizations can improve performance not only by developing skills and providing resources but also by allowing employees the flexibility to balance work and personal life. Ananda (2024) looked at how letting employees work more flexibly affects their ability to balance work and life, and how this in turn affects job performance. that flexible work arrangements improved work-life balance workers reported more time for family and friends, less stress and higher job satisfaction. It also found that those same flexible arrangements led to better employee performance when compared to traditional fixed-schedule work. Experts say that Work Flexibility means that an employee can change their work hours and location as the

organizations offers to make it easier for them to finish their assigned tasks. Work flexibility is increasingly recognized as a vital component of modern employment.

Febriana and Mujib (2024) find that work flexibility improves employee effectiveness and productivity, especially among Generation Z. Work schedule flexibility can significantly improve employees' overall quality of life and mental health. However, such flexibility may produce both beneficial and adverse health outcomes. Flexible work arrangements often promote improved work-life balance, a critical component of mental health, as noted by Ray and Pana-Cryan (2021).

Many organizations are now focusing more on workplace flexibility, seeing it as an important way to improve performance. When employees can shape their work environment to fit their needs, they often feel more motivated and productive.

SUPPORT FROM THE ENVIRONMENT

The presence of organizational strategies or organizational culture that allow for a better balance between employees' personal lives and their functional needs supports the work environment. The main goal of employers who promote a work culture that accommodates both family and work obligations is to increase employee engagement, which will have a harmful effect on productivity due to stress and pressure at work. Ridzuwan, Fakhri and Tenny (2025) explored how flexible working hours affect employees and organizations. They found that giving workers more control over when they work can boost things like adaptability, innovation, and job satisfaction. At the same time, the study pointed out challenges allowing flexible hours may blur the line between work and home life, make team coordination harder, and create unequal access to flexibility. They emphasize that for flexibility to really support work-life balance and performance, companies need inclusive policies, good technology, and a culture that measures outcomes instead of just hours worked. This will not only reduce the stress but also lead to increased productivity and lower absenteeism. This reflects that organizational support is

essential in creating a healthy working environment. Ezhilarasu (2025) showed that when organizations offer things like training, good facilities, flexible hours and motivational leadership, employees felt better able to handle both job demands and personal life. This supportive environment helped reduce stress and improved well-being. The study suggests that to create a healthy work-life balance, organizations must provide not just flexibility but a culture of support that makes employees feel their personal lives matter too.

Emur and Satrya (2024) highlights that employee performance is based on the organizational support and employee balance between professional and personal roles. This study suggests that when the organizations started to give support to their employees, they are ready to do any work any time without any demands. In addition to improving employee satisfaction, a positive and well-managed organizational culture also increases the organization's overall efficacy. Mohammed, Firmansyah, and Djudiyah (2024) reviewed past studies to examine how an organization’s culture affects employee engagement and productivity. They found that organizations with shared values, strong leadership, and clear communication create a supportive work environment where employees feel connected and motivated. This positive environment not only improves engagement but also increases productivity and overall performance. The authors suggest that to foster a healthy and productive workplace, companies should focus on building a culture that supports employees through aligned values, supportive leadership, and everyday practices that consider employee well-being.

Barajas (2024) argues that a strong workplace culture made up of shared values, supportive leadership, and open communication creates an environment where employees feel engaged and perform better. The article shows how culture influences how people behave, work with each other, and commit to their job, and that when culture is positive it leads to higher productivity and stronger engagement. Barajas recommends that organizations actively shape their culture by

supporting collaboration and empowerment, so employees feel connected and motivated to give their best.

To promote employee well-being and improve overall performance, an organization must have a supportive culture that values work-life balance. Businesses create an atmosphere where workers feel appreciated and empowered by implementing flexible work schedules, offering opportunities for advancement, and supporting inspirational leadership. This increases engagement, loyalty, and productivity in addition to lowering stress and absenteeism. In the end, companies that put their workers' personal and professional well-being first create the groundwork for long-term success and a vibrant workplace.

WORK-FAMILY CONFLICT

Work-family conflict describes a scenario where the obligations of a person's job and family life intersect, hindering the ability to meet responsibilities in either domain. This kind of conflict occurs when the demands from work and home clash, making it difficult to fulfill the requirements of one role without hindering the other. Conflict between work and family continues to be a major obstacle to attaining job satisfaction and peak performance at work. Keeping a healthy balance between work and personal duties is important for personal wellness and for preserving competitiveness in the job market. Obrenovic et al. (2020) highlight that unaddressed conflicts between work and family responsibilities can adversely affect employee performance, resulting in lower productivity and dissatisfaction with jobs. These results emphasize the significance of organizational backing in assisting employees in managing the challenges of both areas efficiently.

Shaikh (2025) examines how challenges at work and home can impact family relationships. The research shows that heavy workloads, ongoing stress, and poor communication at home may cause emotional strain and weaken family ties. In contrast, people who talk about

work with their partners and spend quality time with family tend to feel better and maintain a healthier balance. The study showed that people who talked honestly with their partners about work problems and made time for family activities felt better emotionally and had a healthier balance between their job and home life. It proves that good communication and spending quality time with loved ones can really help ease the stress that comes from trying to manage both work and family duties.

When the demands of a job get in the way of responsibilities at home, it can be hard to balance both roles. This is called work-family conflict. This conflict frequently arises when professional responsibilities demand greater time, energy, or attention than familial roles can support. Not everyone can balance these two responsibilities, which can cause stress and problems between work and family life Novitasari, Sasono, and Asbari (2020). However, employees who are mentally ready to adapt and change can better cope with these conflicts, reducing their negative impact on performance. Overall, organizations that provide flexible work policies, supportive environments, and help employees balance work and family responsibilities can improve satisfaction, engagement, and productivity. Sousa and Ferro (2025) recommend that organizations support employees in combining their work and personal lives to help prevent burn out and improve fulfillment. Work-family conflict affects how safe employees feel at work and how well they perform. When work and family demands clash, employees may feel less secure and more stressed, which can lower their job performance.

Work-family conflict will continue to be a problem for manual laborers like porters, especially as the economy gets worse and work conditions get tougher. These workers will probably have to work long hours and be physically tired, which will make I t harder for them to take care of their families. Many people will choose work over personal time because money is still a top priority. This will make them more stressed, this imbalance between work and family

life will get worse if there aren't any supportive policies of flexible work arrangements. The need to work in the future to make labor protections more inclusive and understand the special problem that low-income workers face.

JOB SATISFACTION

Job satisfaction is now seen as a key part of how people behave and perform at work. Atre and Baxi (2024) explain that job satisfaction is shaped by a combination of internal drives, such as the need for personal growth and purpose, and external factors like fairness, recognition, and a healthy work environment. Over time, job satisfaction has proven to be a major influence on how well employees do their jobs, how loyal they are, and how successful a company can be. One of the most important factors influencing operational success is job happiness. Employees may get demotivated and affect the organization's overall performance if they are not sufficiently satisfied. According to Damayanti and Darmawan (2025) job satisfaction is the degree of contentment an individual has with their productivity, which encompasses factors like pay, working hours, workplace, and environment, as well as career advancement opportunities, interpersonal relationships, and management style. Specifically, job satisfaction acts like a boost employee who are happy with their work tend to perform better. A positive, joyful, and highly motivated attitude is exhibited by workers who enjoy their jobs Monga and Soni (2023). The authors suggest that organizations wanting to boost performance should focus on creating jobs that satisfy workers and fuel their motivation.

Employees' positive emotional reactions to their work and surroundings are related to the concept of job satisfaction. The nature of the work, compensation, relationships with coworkers, and the overall work environment are some of the characteristics (Ali and Anwar 2021). Job satisfaction arises from a blend of emotional and environmental factors that allow individuals to

genuinely feel content with their work. It reflects a responsive evaluation of actual job outcomes compared to expected results. This concept is vital because it yields significant benefits for both employees and organizations. For employees, high job satisfaction contributes to overall life happiness. For organizations, it serves as a strategic investment that can enhance performance and productivity (Sutanto, Utami, & Diantoro, 2022). Inegbedion et al. (2020) investigated the relationship between job satisfaction and employees' perceptions of workload balance. According to the study, employees' perceptions of their workloads are greatly influenced by organizational resources, duties alignment with abilities, and peer comparisons of workloads. These factors also have a significant impact on employees' job satisfaction.

For porters, fostering inclusivity and encouraging civic engagement such as teamwork, respect, and shared responsibility, can enhance a sense of belonging and fulfillment at work, leading to job satisfaction. Additionally, Licudan-Credo & Naparota (2022) found that job satisfaction is closely linked to quality of work life, with employees placing high value on respectful treatment and stable working conditions. Porters, whose roles often involve physical labor and unpredictable schedules, can significantly enhance their overall satisfaction by ensuring respectful interactions and consistent working conditions. Miller and Giblin (2023) organizations that offer benefits like flexible work schedules typically have happier and more dedicated employees. When employees had flexible working options and managers took part in leadership cohorts designed to support staff, job satisfaction improved, and staff felt a stronger sense of belonging. Similarly, Yadav and Pandita (2022) report higher levels of job satisfaction and organizational loyalty when they believe their personal and professional lives are harmoniously integrated and found that when there is good work–life integration, job contentment goes up, employees engage more with their work, and the organization’s effectiveness improves as a result. These results highlight how

important it is to match workplace procedures with workers' social and family requirements to foster a more engaged and healthy work environment.

In conclusion, a variety of factors, including physical working conditions, opportunities for advancement, recognition, and compensation, influence porters' job satisfaction. Porters frequently carry out difficult and necessary duties, but when they feel appreciated, supported, and treated fairly, their sense of fulfillment can be greatly increased. In addition to raising employee morale, investments in professional development, fair pay, sufficient downtime, and improved communication also increase productivity and service quality. In the end, encouraging a more dedicated and driven workforce requires an understanding of the critical role porters play in a variety of industries.

WORKING CONDITIONS

Workplace conditions have a significant impact on employee satisfaction and overall organizational performance. Research highlights various aspects of these conditions, such as the physical environment, workload, job stability, and safety protocols, as essential components in evaluating employee satisfaction in their roles. Among the various strategies aimed at enhancing labor welfare, particular emphasis is placed on improving working conditions for manual laborers, including porters. These workers often operate in physically demanding environments, such as markets, transport hubs, and construction sites, where the nature of their tasks exposes them to occupational hazards, fatigue, and social vulnerability.

(Chae, Lee, Kang, & Lee, 2024) investigates the relationship between workplace physicality and psychological factors and employee satisfaction. According to the researchers, ergonomic furniture, sufficient lighting, and easy access to resources are all examples of well-designed workspaces that have a positive impact on job satisfaction. Nonetheless, it has been demonstrated that sociopsychological elements like recognition, work-life balance, and

interpersonal relationships have an even greater influence. Higher levels of satisfaction were reported by workers who felt valued, supported by coworkers and superiors, and had flexibility in juggling work and personal obligations. By combining these variables into a predictive model, the authors found that sociopsychological factors marginally influence job satisfaction more than physical factors. Van et al. (2024) found that when employees feel their workplace supports their well-being and gives them good working conditions, their job satisfaction goes up. In turn, satisfied employees are more likely to engage deeply with their organization. The study highlights that organizations who provide healthy working environments and treat employees as valued partners help improve both the employees' experience and the organization's performance. A sense of motivation and belonging is fostered by inclusive practices, acknowledgment, and creative opportunities. According to their findings, workplace social and emotional factors have a big impact on organizational commitment and performance in addition to pay.

Porters are essential to the efficient operation of passenger and cargo transit, but they are frequently disregarded. Heavy lifting, long hours, exposure to inclement weather, and erratic schedules are all part of their job. Many porters deal with inadequate compensation, restricted access to protective gear, and little job security despite the physically demanding and logistically significant nature of their work. Access to health and safety resources, equitable compensation, and targeted labor protections are necessary to improve their working conditions. Acknowledging their contribution is important for preserving the effectiveness and humanity of port operations, not just for equity.

COMPENSATION

Compensation is vital for influencing individual performance and enhancing overall organizational effectiveness among porters in the port. These employees frequently work under informal agreements, facing reduced job stability and minimal benefits, rendering compensation

not merely a reward but a fundamental aspect of their existence. Compensation is regarded as a key reward that employees receive in exchange for their commitment to an organization, and it serves as one of the primary strategies for enhancing employee productivity. Compensation has a significant impact on how and why people decide to work in both organizational and non-organizational settings, as noted by Adari and Satyanarayana (2018). For porters who perform manual labor, this is especially important because their physically taxing jobs frequently call for long hours and constant effort. In addition to recognizing the worth of their work, fair and sufficient compensation for these employees acts as a motivator that affects their job satisfaction and willingness to stay in their positions. Porters' morale can be greatly impacted, turnover can be decreased, and a more dedicated and effective workforce can be fostered by providing fair compensation and benefits. According to Sitorus and Hidayat (2023) examined how compensation and job satisfaction affect how productively employees at work and there is a significant and favorable correlation between employee productivity and compensation. Corresponding to their findings, employee productivity typically rises when an organization provides fair and competitive compensation. On the other hand, low or inadequate compensation may result in a drop in motivation and performance. This emphasizes how crucial it is to match pay plans with worker expectations to promote productivity, engagement, and long-term retention. It suggests that organizations aiming to boost productivity should ensure compensation is fair and balance it with efforts to improve job satisfaction through good working conditions, recognition, and employee welfare.

Organizations depend on compensation because it attracts, motivates, satisfies, and retains exceptional people. According to Reza and Faisal-E-Alam (2022), the knowledge, abilities, and skills of the workforce are essential resources for enhancing and modifying organizational procedures to gain a competitive advantage. This observation is especially relevant to porters, who

make a substantial contribution to operational effectiveness and service delivery even though they perform physically taxing jobs. Organizations can value porters' labor, promote consistent performance, and lower turnover by providing fair and competitive compensation. In addition to improving the job satisfaction of manual laborers like porters, paying them well also increases the organization's overall ability to uphold high standards and adjust to changing demand. Reddy (2020) found that fair and structured compensation matters a lot for employee performance. When workers believe their pay and benefits match their effort and role, they tend to work harder and deliver better results. It is the main requirement in human resource management which helps improve employee performance and organizational effectiveness. Compensation is something that can directly or indirectly affect the performance of working members. Various compensation components make employees feel safer working in the organization and help them meet their needs.

Sitorus and Hidayat (2023) examined the relationship between compensation, job satisfaction, and employee productivity. Their study found that both compensation and job satisfaction have a positive and significant impact on productivity. Employees who receive fair and competitive compensation are more motivated to perform well, while those who are satisfied with their jobs tend to be more engaged and committed. Organizations aiming to enhance productivity should prioritize strategic compensation practices and foster a work environment that supports employee satisfaction. For porters, fair compensation fosters a sense of job security, which is essential in environments marked by physical strain and unpredictable schedules. It also contributes to job satisfaction, reducing the likelihood of turnover and absenteeism. Employee productivity is closely tied to the compensation they receive.

Zayed et al. (2022) also emphasize that compensation serves as a key indicator of employee motivation and job satisfaction. Their study found that when employees perceive their

compensation as fair and aligned with their contributions, it enhances their motivation, which in turn fosters greater job satisfaction. Satisfied employees are more likely to be engaged, committed, and productive in their roles. Porters whose roles are typically labor-intensive and time-demanding, the absence of formal compensation structured exacerbates the challenge of maintaining a healthy work-life balance. Employee productivity and compensation have a significant and positive relationship, according to Fibriadi, Yusuf, and Abduh (2022). This means that if an organization offers good compensation, employee productivity will increase, and if it offers poor compensation, employee productivity will decrease.

Overall, compensation is very important for an organization to find, keep, and motivate great people. Compensation is a critical factor in shaping employee performance and well-being, especially in informal settings where job security and benefits are limited. Fair, timely, and transparent fosters motivation, job satisfaction, and retention, while also reducing absenteeism and turnover. It enhances employee engagement and organizational effectiveness, particularly for porters, where recognition and financial stability are essential.

COMMUNITY EXTENSION PROGRAM

Community extension programs support porters by addressing their unique challenges, such as physically demanding work and limited resources. Through skills training, financial literacy, health awareness, and social support, these programs aim to improve their well-being, work efficiency, and quality of life.

Ringconada and Eguia (2025) developed and validated a scale to measure the sustainability of community extension initiatives in Philippine state universities and colleges. The study emphasized that sustainable programs require careful planning, consistent evaluation, and active community involvement. In relation to manual workers or porters, this suggests that well-

structured extension programs such as skills training, financial literacy, and health support can improve their long-term well-being, work efficiency, and overall quality of life. Sustainable initiatives help ensure that support for porters is not temporary but continues to foster social and economic improvement over time. Olila (2021) emphasized the need for a careful and objective evaluation framework for extension projects to ensure sustainability. Well-planned community extension programs can improve community well-being while promoting social change.

This study highlights the importance of understanding work-life balance and job satisfaction among porters at Nasipit Port, a group that has received little research attention. Community extension programs play a crucial role by directly improving workers' conditions, reducing stress, promoting health, and recognizing their contributions. The findings will also support policymakers in creating fair labor policies and guide future research, while contributing to the broader knowledge on labor practices and work-life balance.

1.3 Theoretical Framework

Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs

Abraham Maslow (1943) suggested that human motivation is influenced by a hierarchy of needs, starting with physiological and safety needs, followed by social belonging, esteem, and reaching self-actualization at the peak. This theory proposes that people need to fulfill basic needs such as work stability, support from the environment, and relief from work-family conflict before they can chase higher-level aspirations like personal development and work-life balance. According to Alkema (2024), using Maslow's ideas at work helps people see why some employees do not get involved until their basic needs are met. Tanner (2025) agrees, saying the motivation and satisfaction are closely tied to how well an individual meets each need.

In their 2020 publication Organizational Behavior (19th ed.), Robbins and Judge discuss the relevance of Maslow's hierarchy of needs to today's work environment. They demonstrate that flexible work options can enhance employee motivation. They say that these setups meet important psychological needs which are very important in Maslow's hierarchy. Jeffrey H. Greenhaus and Nicholas J. Allen (2011) examined the impact of work-family conflict on the well-being of employees. They focused on how unresolved conflict undermines psychological safety and a sense of belonging two essential elements of Maslow's lower-tier needs. The findings indicate that when employees have difficulty managing work and family duties, their motivation and engagement levels decline. According to this, to create a supportive environment, organizations need to take proactive measures to address work-family conflict. Employees' basic psychological needs are safeguarded in this way, and they are also free to pursue more ambitious goals like self-actualization and self-esteem. Maslow (1968) believed that organizations that promote independence, creativity, and values like responsibility for the environment can help

individuals achieve fulfillment and even excellence. These results highlight how essential it is to create workplaces that satisfy both basic needs and higher objectives.

Even with its benefits, Maslow's theory has shortcomings. It presumes a linear advancement within the hierarchy, which might not accurately represent the real experiences of porters who currently prioritize safety and belonging, or regard and financial security. Nonetheless, Maslow's theory continues to be an important resource for understanding how work-life balance impacts job satisfaction, particularly when placed within the wider context of employees' needs. This highlights that work-life balance is a vital factor influencing job satisfaction, especially among porters who face physically demanding tasks and irregular schedules. Studies reveal that when employees can effectively manage their professional duties alongside personal life, employees experience higher levels of satisfaction, motivation, and overall well-being. This suggests that targeted interventions such as flexible scheduling and community-based support can significantly improve porters' work-life balance and job satisfaction. Insightssights provide a strong foundation for designing a community extension program that addresses the unique challenges faced by porters in balancing their work and personal life.

Herzberg's Two-Factor Theory

Created by Frederick Herzberg (1959), the Two-Factor Theory was also referred to as the Motivation-Hygiene Theory, differentiating between hygiene factors and motivators as essential influences of job satisfaction (Herzberg, Mausner, & Snyderman, 1959). Hygiene factors encompass aspects like compensation and stable working conditions. Conversely, motivators like acknowledgment, career growth opportunities**,** and personal development are inherent to the role and result in increased satisfaction when they are available (Nickerson, 2024; Kincaid, 2025).

Growth opportunities, accomplishment, and meaningful work are intrinsic motivators that encourage employee engagement and satisfaction, according to (Ivancevich, Konopaske, &

Matteson, 2023). Compensation, job security, and working conditions, on the other hand, are classified as hygiene factors aspects that are necessary to avoid dissatisfaction. Herzberg's theory helps explain why porters, who often do physical labor, work long hours, and have few chances to advance in their jobs, could be unhappy with their jobs even if others of them are fine. On the other hand, porters are happier at work when they are given chances to grow and be recognized. This is in line with the recent research in workplace psychology that has found both characteristics are important for making a work environment that is productive and satisfying. Organizations that actively recognize employee contributions and offer clear career development pathways foster greater affective commitment, assert Zhu Jia-jun & Song Hua-ming (2022). Overall organizational loyalty and performance are improved by this emotional connection between workers and their place of employment. According to their research, workers are more likely to be content with their positions and stick with them when they feel supported by their organizations and have opportunities for professional development. Developing a theoretical framework that connects intrinsic motivation to job satisfaction and long-term retention requires this understanding.

This study highlights how work-life balance and job satisfaction are connected yet different factors that affect employee well-being. Work-life balance which includes work flexibility, a supportive environment, and managing work-family conflict helps employees maintain stability between their jobs and personal lives. Job satisfaction, on the other hand, involves factors such as career growth opportunities, good working conditions, and fair pay. Based on Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs, porters may focus first on meeting their basic needs, such as safety, job security, and enough income, before seeking higher needs like personal fulfillment and a balanced life. Herzberg's Two-Factor Theory helps explain this better by showing that work-life balance can act as both a hygiene factor and a motivator. Flexibility and supportive conditions can prevent dissatisfaction, while growth opportunities and recognition can increase happiness and

engagement. Overall, these ideas show that improving both work-life balance and job satisfaction can lead to greater motivation and well-being among porters.

The relationship between Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs and Herzberg's Two-Factor Theory and Quality of Work Life is examined in a recent study that was published in the International Journal for Multidisciplinary Research (2024). The study emphasizes how Quality of Work Life components like career progression, work-life balance, and equitable compensation have a direct impact on worker happiness and motivation. The study by Al-Omari, Hanandeh, Al-Somaidaee, Al Jarraha, and Alnajdawi (2020) identifies key dimensions of work-life balance work flexibility, supportive environment, work-family conflict, and career growth opportunities that influence employee satisfaction. The study also notes that working conditions and compensation affect employee satisfaction. This framework provides the variables and dimensions that guide our research on the relationship between work-life balance and employee satisfaction in the hospitality sector.

The variables included in the study were adapted from the work of AL-Omari et al. (2020), who examined the impact of work-life balance on employee satisfaction in five-star hotels. In this study, work-life balance is represented through work flexibility, support from the environment, and work-family conflict, while job satisfaction is measured by working conditions and compensation. These variables are grounded in Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs, which emphasizes the fulfillment of physiological, safety, and social needs, and Herzberg's Two-Factor Theory, which distinguishes between hygiene factors including working conditions and compensation and motivators that contribute to job satisfaction.

1.4 Schematic Diagram

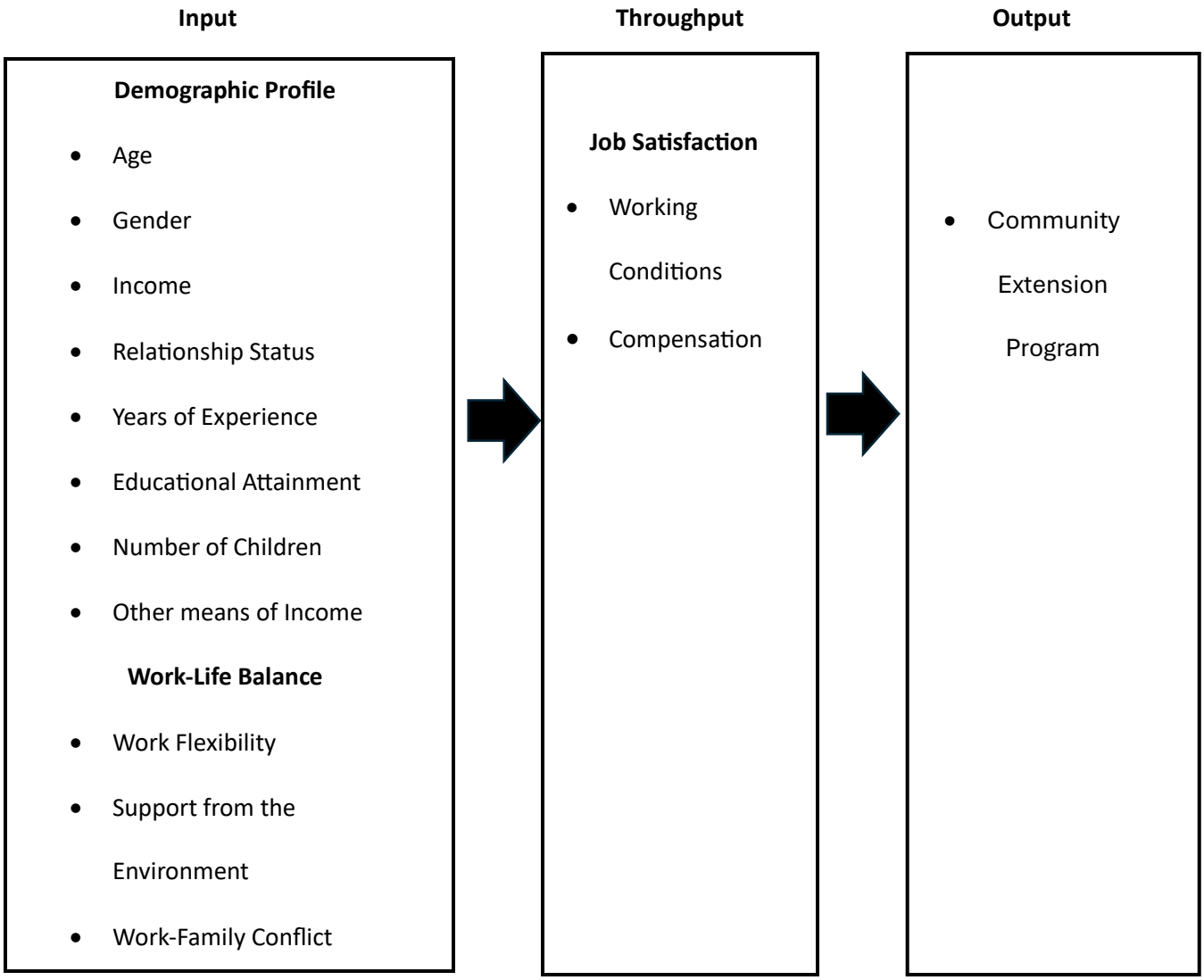


Figure 1. The Schematic Diagram shows the interplay between the input, throughput, and output of the study

1.5 Statement of the Problem/ Objectives of the Study

This study seeks to explore the relationship between work-life balance and job satisfaction among porters and to answer the questions outlined below:

1. What is the demographic profile of Porters in terms of:

    1.1 age

    1.3 gender

    1.4 income

    1.5 relationship status

    1.6 years of experience

    1.7 educational attainment

    1.8 number of children

    1.9 other means of income

2. To what extent does the impact of work-life balance among porters in terms of:

    2.1 work flexibility

    2.2 support from the environment

    2.3 work-family conflict

3. To what extent does the impact of job satisfaction among porters in terms of:

    3.1 working conditions

    3.2 compensation

4. Is there a significant relationship between work-life balance and job satisfaction among porters?

5. What community extension program can be proposed to enhance the work-life balance and Job satisfaction among porters?

1.6 Scope and Limitations

This study examines the work-life balance and its impact on job satisfaction among porters at Talisay Port in Nasipit, Agusan del Norte, particularly those employed as laborers to assist passengers with their luggage. The research, which will be conducted during the 2025-2026 academic year, aims to understand the unique challenges faced by porters, including physically demanding duties, irregular working hours, inadequate rest, and the pressure of managing familial responsibilities. The study aims to establish baseline data for a community extension program that enhances well-being and encourages sustainable livelihood practices by analyzing the impact of these factors on job satisfaction.

The data was gathered using survey questionnaires that the porters answered personally, making sure that the results were based on their own experiences and points of view. The study also lays the groundwork for creating a community extension program that helps people live better lives and supports ways of making a living that are good for the environment. The study is limited to porters at Talisay Port, which may limit the applicability of the findings to other ports or labor sectors. Only those who were available and willing to take part in the data collection were included.

1.7 Hypothesis

Null Hypothesis (H_o)

There is no significant relationship between work-life balance and job satisfaction among porters.

Alternative Hypothesis (H_1)

There is a significant relationship between work-life balance and job satisfaction among porters.

1.8 Definition of Terms

The following important terms are defined as they are used in the context of this research to guarantee clarity and consistency throughout the study.

Age. The duration of an individual's life since birth.

Community Extension Program. An initiative that uses the findings on porters' work-life balance and job satisfaction to design programs or activities that improve their well-being, working conditions, and overall quality of life.

Compensation. Payment and benefits that porters receive for performing tasks.

Educational Attainment. The highest level of education a porter has completed.

Gender. Identities associated with being male, female, or another identity.

Income. Refers to how much money a person earns.

Job Satisfaction. Referring to how Porter's content and fulfilled they feel with their work, including their duties, treatment, compensation, and overall work environment.

Number of Children. The total count of a respondent's biological or legally adopted children.

Other means of Income. Refers to any additional source of earnings aside from a porter's main job, such as small businesses, sideline activities, part-time work, or remittances received from family members working abroad.

Porters. Workers in port areas who assist travelers and passengers by carrying, loading, and unloading personal luggage are responsible for safely and efficiently moving bags from vehicles to terminals and helping passengers throughout the check-in process.

Relationship Status. A person's current romantic or family situation. It shows whether someone is single, married, in a relationship, separated, divorced, or widowed.

Support from the Environment. Referring to the assistance porters receive from their workplace surroundings, including cooperation from coworkers, understanding from supervisors, and access to resources that help them do their job effectively and with less stress.

Work Flexibility. The extent to which workers can modify their work schedules to better fit their own requirements and preferences.

Work-Family Conflict. Referring to when the demands of a job and the responsibilities at home clash, making it harder for porters to balance both.

Work-life Balance. Refers to their ability to manage physically demanding and irregular work duties while still having enough time and energy for personal and family life.

Working Conditions. Referring to the environmental factors that affect how porters do their jobs, where workers stay healthy, safe, and productive.

Years of Experience. The total length of time a porter has spent working in a specific job, and how long the individual has been performing their duties.

CHAPTER 2

METHODOLOGY

This section provides an overview of the techniques used for gathering data and analyzing pertinent research findings. The methods that were discussed include the research design, research locale, research respondents, research instrument, and ethical standards, data gathering procedures, and data analysis plan and procedures.

2.1 Research Design

This study will adopt a quantitative descriptive correlational research design to examine the relationship between work-life balance and job satisfaction among porters. It will aim to identify measurable patterns and associations between the two variables without manipulating any conditions. Data will be collected through survey questionnaires and analyzed to determine the strength and direction of the correlation. Findings from this study will inform the development of targeted community extension programs that address the specific needs and challenges faced by porters.

2.2 Research Locale

The study will be conducted at Nasipit Port in Talisay, Nasipit, Agusan del Norte, a major gateway for cargo and passenger movement in the Caraga Region. As a base port with continuous commercial and logistic activity, it manages substantial vessel traffic, cargo operations, and passenger flow throughout the year. The Nasipit Porters Organization is a group of porters who carry, load, unload, and transport goods within the port. It coordinates daily tasks, maintains efficient operations, and serves as a link between port management and workers. Due to their demanding duties, irregular schedules, and physically intensive work, the organization provides a relevant population for examining work-life balance, job satisfaction, and related socioeconomic concerns.

2.3 Research Respondents

The study will involve 40 porters working at Nasipit Port in Talisay, Nasipit, Agusan del Norte, Philippines. Complete Enumeration Sampling is used in this study because the total population of 40 porters at Nasipit Port is small, allowing the researcher to include all members to capture their experiences comprehensively and produce accurate, representative findings. Their direct involvement in cargo handling and passenger assistance will place them in unique and challenging conditions, making their experiences essential for understanding the realities of port work. Moreover, there will be a noticeable lack of focus on porters in existing literature, which will further highlight the importance of examining their working conditions and well-being to develop targeted programs that support this often-overlooked workforce.

Table 1. Respondents of the study

The table shows the total population of porters working at Nasipit Port.

RESPONDENTS	POPULATION	FREQUENCY	PERCENTAGE
Nasipit Porters	40	40	100%

2.4 Research Instrument

This study will used a modified survey questionnaire as its primary research instrument to gather quantitative data on the work-life balance and job satisfaction of porters at Nasipit Port that integrates Paul E. Spector's Job Satisfaction Survey (JJS, 1985) provides a reliable framework for measuring key dimensions of job satisfaction using a standardized Likert-scale format and the study of Dr. Vinod Damodar Malap and Prof. Dr. Pratik Rajan Mungkar, Work-Life Balance: A Gendered Perspective (2024) by addressing how gender roles influence the balance between professional and personal life.

The survey questionnaire consist of three parts: (1) the demographic profile of the respondents, including age, gender, income, relationship status, years of experience, educational

attainment, number of children, and other means of income; (2) items measuring the work-life balance including work flexibility, support from the environment, and work-family conflict; (3) items measuring the impact of job satisfaction, including working conditions and compensation. These parts of the survey questionnaire will examine the impact of work-life balance on job satisfaction among porters. The instrument used a Likert scale format to measure the degree of agreement with each statement.

Table 2. Scale Description

Scale	Verbal Description	Verbal Interpretation
4	Strongly Agree (SA)	If the statement is completely acceptable to the opinion of the respondents. *(Kung ang pahayag kay sakto kayo sa opinyon sa responde).*
3	Agree(A)	If the statement is acceptable to the opinion of the respondents. *(Kung ang pahayag kay sakto ra sa opinyon sa responde).*
2	Disagree(D)	If the statement is not acceptable to the opinion of the respondents. *(Kung ang pahayag kay dili uyon sa opinyon sa responde).*
1	Strongly Disagree (DA)	If the statement is completely unacceptable to the opinion of the respondents. *(Kung ang pahayag kay dili jud uyon sa opinyon sa responde).*

2.5 Research Ethical Standards

A. Intellectual Property Rights (IPR)

This study did not encompass the creation of new technologies, processes, and products necessitating patent protection. The research instrument employed to evaluate the work-life balance and its impact on job satisfaction among porters was created by a different author and is used with formal authorization. The research also did not include any unique branding elements, like a logo or symbol.

B. Informed Consent

All respondents in the study were provided with informed consent forms that explained the research objectives. The research procedures involve answering a survey questionnaire. All the information collected will be kept completely private and only used for academic and program development purposes. No reports or publications will include any information that could be used to identify someone personally. The study presents no identifiable risks to participants, and although direct benefits may not be immediate, the findings may enhance support systems for porters.

C. Data Privacy and Confidentiality

In accordance with ethical standards, the researchers will be maintained and protected the confidentiality of the participants and identities will not be disclosed at any stage of the research. The data collected will be securely stored and accessed exclusively by researchers for academic and program development purposes. We won't share any personal information with anyone else, and we'll report the results in a way that doesn't let people know who the individual participants are.

D. Voluntary Participation

In this study, the respondents were volunteers. Individuals invited to take part are under no obligation to participate and may decline or withdraw from study at any point without facing

any form of penalty of loss of benefits. The researchers will respect each participant's autonomy and decision throughout the research process.

E. Minimization of Harm

The research design will be carefully planned to avoid any physical, psychological, social, or legal risks. Participants will not go through any procedures that may cause discomfort or distress. All survey questions will be private and used only for academic purposes. To ensure clarity and understanding, the survey questionnaires will be translated into Bisaya. If any participant feels uncomfortable, they will be free to skip questions or leave the study at any time without any consequences. The researchers will create a respectful and supportive environment during data collection, making sure the dignity, rights, and well-being of all participants are always protected.

F. Beneficence

The researchers are committed to conducting the study in a manner that promotes the well-being of all participants, aiming to generate insights that can lead to meaningful improvements in their work-life conditions. The study is designed to avoid any form of harm and to minimize potential benefits, particularly through the development of a community extension program that addresses the specific needs of porters. By participating, individuals contribute to a research initiative that seeks to enhance job satisfaction, support personal well-being, and foster a more balanced and productive work environment.

G. Justice and Fair Participants Selection

The study will follow to the ethical principles of justice by ensuring fair and equitable selection of participants. Porters who are invited to participate are chosen based on their relevance to the study's objectives, without discrimination based on age, gender, ethnicity, religion, or socioeconomic status. The selection process is designed to provide equal opportunity for all eligible individuals to contribute, ensuring that the benefits and burdens of research are

distributed. This approach promoted inclusiveness and respects the dignity and rights of all participants.

H. Data Integrity and Accuracy

The researcher used clear and organized methods to ensure accurate and consistent data collection and analysis. All data collected will be recorded, analyzed, and reported with honesty, transparency, and precision. The researchers commit to avoiding any form of data fabrication, falsification, or misrepresentation. Responses will be transcribed and encoded faithfully, ensuring that the findings reflect the true experiences and perspective of the participants. Any errors identified during the research process will be promptly corrected, and all procedures will be conducted in accordance with established academic and ethical standards and the credibility of the study.

I. Transparency in Reporting

The researchers commit to presenting findings honestly, clearly, and without distortion. All methodologies, data analyses, and results will be documented accurately and disclosed in full, ensuring that interpretations are based on the verifiable evidence. Any limitations, potential biases, or conflicts of interest will be openly acknowledged to maintain the integrity of the research. The final report will reflect the true outcomes of the study and will be made available to stakeholders, participants, and relevant institutions to promote accountability and informed decision-making.

J. Use of Patented or Copyrighted Materials

All resources, tools, and references utilized by the researcher, such as published articles, survey instruments, will be properly cited and used in accordance with intellectual property laws. No copyrighted content will be reproduced without permission, and any materials requiring authorization will be obtained before use. The researchers commit to respecting the rights of

original creators and ensuring that all borrowed content is acknowledged to maintain academic integrity and avoid infringement.

K. Ethical Considerations for Animals and Human Trials

This study only involves human participants and does not include any form of animal testing. The researchers ensure that all procedures involving human subjects strictly adhere to ethical guidelines for research, including respect for autonomy, informed consent, confidentiality, and the minimization of harm. Participants are selected fairly and treated with dignity throughout the research process. The study has been designed to ensure that no physical, psychological, or social risks are imposed on individuals, and all data will be handled with integrity and transparency.

L. Responsible Use of AI and Related Technologies

The researchers used AI tools such as Quillbot and Grammarly; these platforms were utilized to enhance the clarity, coherence, and grammatical accuracy of the research. Their use was limited to language refinement and did not alter the original meaning, data interpretation, or integrity of the findings. The researchers ensured that all content remained authentic, and that the use of AI tools complied with ethical standards for academic purposes. Proper citations and acknowledgments were maintained throughout to uphold transparency and intellectual honesty.

M. Ethical Approval

The Institutional Review Board (IRB) of Saint Michael College of Caraga will review and approve the study titled Work-Life Balance and Its Impact on Job Satisfaction Among Porters: Basis for Community Extension Program. This approval will affirm the study's adherence to ethical standards concerning participant protection, data privacy, and intellectual property rights. Through the IRB process, the rights and welfare of respondents will be safeguarded, ensuring that the research will be conducted with integrity, transparency, and respect for all ethical considerations.

N. Disposal

All data collected from participants, including questionnaires and digital records, will be securely stored for the duration of the study. After the completion of the research and any required reporting, physical documents will be shredded, and digital files will be permanently deleted to ensure confidentiality. No personal identifiers will be retained beyond the study period, safeguarding participants' privacy in accordance with ethical research standards.

2.6 Data Gathering Procedures

The researchers followed these procedures in gathering data.

Permission to Conduct the Study: Researchers will send a formal letter requesting permission to conduct the study to the head of porters in Talisay, Nasipit, Agusan del Norte. The letter was noted by the research adviser, approved by the OIC-Dean of Saint Michael College of Caraga.

Orientation to participants: The researchers will give the participating porters a quick orientation before delivering the questionnaires. This session will include an explanation of the study's goal, a focus on voluntary participation and anonymity, and guidance on how to complete the questionnaire correctly. This stage will guarantee that participants fully comprehend the questions and are at ease discussing their experiences.

Distribution of Questionnaire: The researchers will distribute the questionnaires to the respondents, who will be porters working in Nasipit Port. The distribution will be done personally to ensure proper guidance and to address any questions regarding the items in the questionnaires.

Gathering of Questionnaires: After the respondents complete the questionnaires, the researchers will collect them and examine each response individually to ensure completeness and accuracy.

Consolidating Data: The collected data will be checked, tabulated, and organized. With the assistance of a statistician, that data will be analyzed and interpreted using appropriate statistical

tools to generate insights on the relationship between work-life balance and job satisfaction among porters.

2.7 Data Analysis Plan and Procedures

Statistical treatment will make the collected data easier to interpret and analyze. This will be the stage where researchers will analyze their data, formulate conclusions, and make informed decisions.

The researchers analyzed and interpreted the data using the following statistical tools.

Frequency and Percentage: This tool will be used to answer the first problem, which focuses on determining the demographic profile of porters in terms of age, gender, income, relationship status, years of experience, educational attainment, number of children, and other means of income. The distribution of respondents across each category will be clearly presented by frequency and percentage, which will help in understanding the diversity and background of the porter population.

Weighted Men: The mean was used to address Problems 2 and 3, which focused on examining the extent of work-life balance and job satisfaction among porters. Providing a focus on work flexibility, support from the environment, work-family conflict, working conditions, and compensation, the mean was utilized to assess the influence of work-life balance and job satisfaction among porters. It helped evaluate how these factors affected their performance and well-being by providing a clear average of responses.

Spearman Rho Correlation: Spearman Rho Correlation was used to address Problem 4, which examined the significant relationship between work-life balance and job satisfaction among porters. This statistical tool supported in determining the relationship between ranked variables, including compensation, working conditions, career growth opportunities, work-family conflict, work flexibility, and support the environment. By examining these connections, Spearman Rho

Correlation demonstrated whether increases in work-life balance were associated with greater job satisfaction, providing important information about how these elements interact to affect porter performance and well-being.

2.8 References

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